
TUNISIAN BACCALAUREAT EXAM REVISION SYSTEM

ENGLISH REVISION SUITE

UNIT 2: EDUCATION MATTERS

CHAPTER 15: AGE OR...? (ABILITY-BASED LEARNING)

Comprehensive Excellence Review Booklet

Fully Aligned with the Tunisian Ministry of Education Syllabus (Skills for Life)

Thematic Vocabulary • Prepositions with Verbs • Word Stress Mastery • 40 Active Recall Q&As •
Evaluation Quiz

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PART 1: THE EXHAUSTIVE COURSE THEORY

1.1 Case Study: Ability-Based Learning at Bridgemary School

In traditional schooling systems, pupils are grouped and taught strictly based on chronological age. However, **Bridgemary School in Gosport, Hampshire** (England) introduced a radical and pioneering initiative by switching completely to **ability-based streaming** in mixed-age classes to tackle low standards and under-achievement. Under the leadership of headmistress **Mrs. Cheryl Heron**, the school transformed traditional tutor groups into multi-age 'learning groups'. Instead of being restricted by age, children's levels are assessed via formal diagnostic tests and teacher judgments, and they are allocated to one of 5 distinct skill tiers ranging from basic literacy to advanced pre-university courses. This personalized approach prevents fast learners from getting bored while ensuring struggling students receive tailored, focused support.

1.2 Core Thematic Lexicon for Chapter 15

Here is the essential vocabulary from the lesson that frequently appears in the Baccalauréat reading comprehension, synonym search, and word-building exercises:

Key Term	Part of Speech & Definition	Exam-Oriented Contextual Example
assess	Verb: To evaluate or estimate the nature, ability, or quality of someone or something.	Before placing students in learning levels, teachers assess their skill through tests.
boost	Verb: To help or encourage something to increase, improve, or become stronger.	Group division based on academic ability is aimed to boost the school's overall performance.
deprived	Adjective: Lacking the necessity of life; poor, disadvantaged.	The school is located in a deprived urban area where children face economic hardships.
tackle	Verb: To make determined efforts to deal with or solve a difficult problem.	The radical system was designed to tackle a persistent culture of under-achievement.
numeracy	Noun: The ability to understand and work with numbers (basic mathematics).	Students in the Access Level focus primarily on fundamental literacy and numeracy .

Key Term	Part of Speech & Definition	Exam-Oriented Contextual Example
stream	Verb/Noun: To put school students into groups according to their academic ability.	Around 60% of secondary schools stream their pupils to some extent, experts estimate.
switch	Noun/Verb: A complete change from one system or method to another.	The total switch to mixed-age classes attracted widespread national monitoring and interest.
comprehensive	Adjective/Noun: A state secondary school in the UK for children of all abilities.	Some educational critics feared that ability streaming moved away from the comprehensive ideal.

HEADMISTRESS INSIGHT (MRS. CHERYL HERON)

"Children get bored or their behaviour can get challenging if they are not being pushed because the academic levels within the same class are too different. If the children are able and bright, why should we stop them?"

1.3 Advanced Grammar: Dependent Prepositions with Verbs & Adjectives

A highly recurring section in the Baccalauréat grammar paper is the correct use of **dependent prepositions** that accompany specific verbs and adjectives. In English, these pairs are fixed (collocations) and must be memorized. Below is the official syntactic chart from the lesson text:

Verb / Adjective	Preposition	Syntactic Pattern & Meaning	Exam Model Sentence
aimed	at	aim + at + V-ing/Noun (intended to achieve)	The new system is aimed at tackling the low levels of success.
allocated	to	allocate + Noun + to + Noun (assigned to)	The pupils are evaluated and allocated to one of five levels.
deal	with	deal + with + Noun (to handle or take action)	The Access Level deals with very basic math and reading skills.
equivalent	to	equivalent + to + Noun (equal in value/class)	Level 3 is equivalent to advanced A-level standard courses.

Verb / Adjective	Preposition	Syntactic Pattern & Meaning	Exam Model Sentence
transform	into	transform + Noun + into + Noun (completely change)	They transformed traditional tutor groups into mixed-age sets.
care	about	care + about + Noun (feel concern or interest)	I care about whether these pupils are achieving their potential.
depend	on	depend + on + Noun (determined or conditioned by)	Your final placement will depend on tests and teacher judgments.
suffer	from	suffer + from + Noun (to experience distress/pain)	Struggling children will no longer suffer from intense peer pressure.

1.4 Phonetics Module: Syllable Stress in Educational Terms

The Tunisian Baccalauréat phonetic section frequently tests your ability to identify the **stressed syllable** (accentuation tonique) in polysyllabic words. The general rules and shifts tested in this lesson include:

- **Stress on 1st Syllable:**

- **personalised** /'pɜːsənəlaɪzd/ - **numeracy** /'njuːməɾəsi/ - **forward** /'fɔːwəd/

- **Stress on 2nd Syllable:**

- **ability** /ə'bɪlɪti/ - **assessed** /ə'sest/ - **deprived** /dɪ'praɪvd/ - **together** /tə'geðə/

- **Stress on 3rd Syllable:**

- under-**achievement** /ˌʌndərə'tʃiːvmənt/ - indi-**vidual** /ˌɪndɪ'vɪdʒuəl/ - re-**collect** /ˌrekə'lekt/

PHONETICAL ALERT

WORD CLASS STRESS SHIFT: Note how the stress shifts dynamically when words change forms. For example, the noun **person** /'pɜːsn/ has stress on the first syllable, whereas the derived adjective **personalised** /pə'sɜːnəlaɪzd/ maintains stress but secondary stress shifts, and **able** /'eɪbl/ shifts to **ability** /ə'bɪlɪti/ (stress moves to the second syllable).

1.5 Data Analysis: Student Distribution & Streaming Mechanics

According to Ofsted reports, the radical streaming system implemented at Bridgemary School organizes pupils across five levels based on strict diagnostic tests. The horizontal bar chart below depicts the typical proportional allocation of the student body, highlighting how the school ensures personalization by catering to both low achievers (Access/Entry) and high achievers (Level 3):

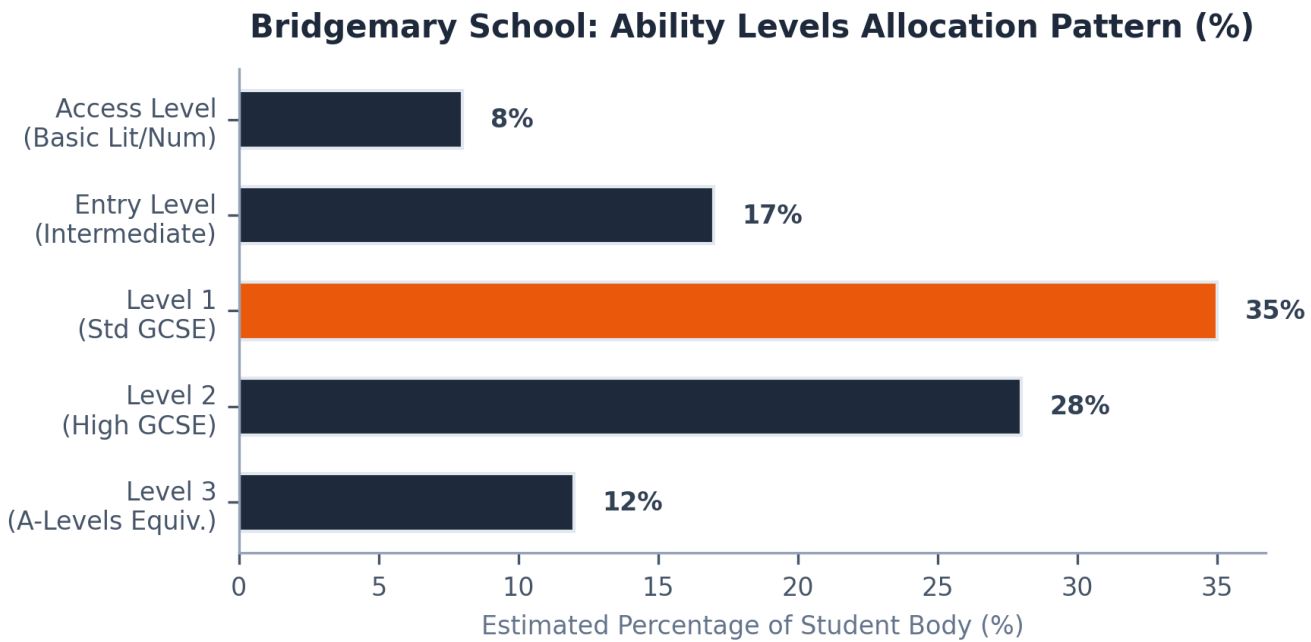


Figure 1.1: Proportional distribution of pupils across Bridgemary's 5 ability-based levels.

PART 2: THE ACTIVE RECALL REPOSITORY - 40 QUESTIONS-ANSWERS

This repository contains exactly 40 exam-style flashcards specifically formulated for active recall revision of Chapter 15. The left column lists targeted exam questions, while the right column contains comprehensive, high-scoring answers. Tip: Cover the right column to test your knowledge!

No. & Question	Detailed Model Answer / Grammar Key
Q1: What is the primary theme of Chapter 15 'Age or...?'	The primary theme is alternative and personalized learning, specifically teaching pupils according to their academic ability rather than their age.
Q2: Where is Bridgemary School located?	It is located in Gosport, Hampshire, which is a deprived urban area in England.
Q3: Who is the headmistress of Bridgemary School?	The headmistress who pioneered this radical ability-based teaching initiative is Mrs. Cheryl Heron.
Q4: What was the school's classification before the scheme?	The schools watchdog Ofsted had classed Bridgemary as having 'serious weaknesses' with most pupils failing to gain five good GCSEs.
Q5: What is Ofsted?	Ofsted is the official schools watchdog and inspection authority in England that monitors and grades school performance.
Q6: How many pupils attend Bridgemary School and what are their ages?	The school has approximately 1,100 pupils aged between 11 and 16 years old.
Q7: What are the five ability levels introduced under the scheme?	The five ability levels are Access, Entry, Level One, Level Two, and Level Three.
Q8: What does the 'Access' level specifically focus on?	The Access level deals with basic numeracy and literacy skills for students who are struggling academically.

No. & Question	Detailed Model Answer / Grammar Key
Q9: What is the academic equivalent of 'Level Three'?	Level Three is equivalent to advanced pre-university courses, also known as A-levels.
Q10: What did Ofsted call Mrs. Cheryl Heron?	Ofsted described her as an 'excellent leader who was driving the school forward' due to her decisive and innovative reforms.
Q11: How are pupils assessed before being allocated to a level?	Pupils are assessed via rigorous diagnostic tests and teacher judgments for each subject individually.
Q12: What are 'mixed-age classes'?	They are classes where older and younger children (e.g., 12-year-olds and 15-year-olds) study together because they share the same academic ability.
Q13: Who is Dr. Faysal Mikdadi?	He is the chairman of governors at Bridgemary School and also serves as an Ofsted inspector.
Q14: What did Dr. Mikdadi say about comprehensive ideals?	He defiantly stated that he 'could not care less about an ideal' as long as the children are achieving their full potential.
Q15: How did critics originally view ability-based streaming?	Critics previously condemned ability-based streaming as 'anti-comprehensive', fearing it created segregation among pupils.
Q16: What is the primary benefit of ability grouping for bright students?	It ensures bright students are pushed academically and prevents them from getting bored or disengaged in class.
Q17: What is the primary benefit for slower students?	Struggling students are placed in classes with younger peers where they can master reading, writing, and math without falling behind.
Q18: What percentage of secondary schools in England use some form of streaming?	It is estimated that approximately 60 percent of secondary schools employ some form of streaming.
Q19: Why is the Bridgemary scheme described as 'unheard of'?	Because of its level of personalization, where pupils are streamed dynamically for each subject, rather than being put in fixed blocks.

No. & Question	Detailed Model Answer / Grammar Key
Q20: Which preposition always accompanies the verb 'assess' in the passive?	The verb 'assess' is followed by 'via' or 'by' (e.g., 'they will be assessed via tests').
Q21: Complete the sentence with the correct preposition: 'Pupils are allocated _____ a level.'	The correct preposition is 'to'. We say: 'allocated to one of five levels'.
Q22: Fill in the blank: 'The new personalized system was aimed _____ tackling under-achievement.'	The correct preposition is 'at'. We say: 'aimed at tackling the culture'.
Q23: Which preposition follows 'equivalent'?	The correct preposition is 'to'. We say: 'level three is equivalent to A-levels'.
Q24: Fill in the blank: 'The school transformed traditional tutor groups _____ mixed-age groups.'	The correct preposition is 'into'. We say: 'transformed traditional tutor groups into mixed-age groups'.
Q25: Complete: 'I could not care less _____ an ideal.'	The correct preposition is 'about'. We say: 'care less about an ideal'.
Q26: Which preposition follows 'suffer'?	The correct preposition is 'from'. We say: 'suffer from learning difficulties'.
Q27: Complete: 'To what extent does a student's success depend _____ their effort?'	The correct preposition is 'on'. We say: 'depend on their effort'.
Q28: Which preposition completes: 'Our school is independent _____ age-based rules.'	The correct preposition is 'of'. We say: 'independent of age'.

No. & Question	Detailed Model Answer / Grammar Key
Q29: What part of speech is 'numeracy' and what is its adjective form?	'Numeracy' is a noun. Its adjective form is 'numerical' (or 'numerate' when referring to a person).
Q30: What is the noun form of the verb 'assess'?	The noun form of the verb 'assess' is 'assessment'.
Q31: What are the noun, verb, and adjective forms of 'provision'?	The verb is 'provide', the noun is 'provision' (or 'provider'), and the adjective is 'provocative' or 'provided' (participle).
Q32: Translate the adjective 'deprived' into French, and what is its antonym?	'Deprived' means 'démuni' or 'défavorisé' in French. Its antonym is 'privileged' or 'wealthy'.
Q33: Translate 'under-achievement' and explain its meaning in the context of the school.	It translates to 'sous-réalisation' or 'échec scolaire'. It refers to a school culture where students perform far below their actual academic potential.
Q34: Where does the stress fall in the word 'ability'?	The stress falls on the second syllable: a- bil -i-ty (/ə'bɪlɪti/).
Q35: Where does the stress fall in 'personalised'?	The stress falls on the first syllable: per -son-al-ised (/ˈpɜːsənəlaɪzd/).
Q36: Identify the stressed syllable in 'under-achievement'.	The primary stress falls on the third syllable of the base word 'achievement': under-a- chieve -ment (/ˌʌndərə'tʃiːvmənt/).
Q37: What phonetic shift happens between the verb 'separate' and the adjective 'separate'?	The verb is pronounced with a long 'a' in the last syllable (/ˈsepəreɪt/), whereas the adjective is pronounced with a short weak 'i' or schwa (/ˈseprət/).
Q38: How do you pronounce the 'th' in 'Northern' compared to 'North'?	In the noun 'North', the 'th' is voiceless (/θ/). In the derived adjective 'Northern', it shifts to voiced (/ð/).

No. & Question	Detailed Model Answer / Grammar Key
Q39: What is Mrs. Cheryl Heron's ultimate goal for the students?	Her ultimate goal is to break the local culture of under-achievement and help all students reach their full academic potential.
Q40: What is the attitude of the chairman of governors toward comprehensive ideals?	He is highly pragmatic and defiant; he values actual student achievement and potential far more than abstract educational dogmas.

PART 3: EVALUATION QUIZ & SUMMARY MEMOS

3.1 Diagnostic Evaluation Quiz (10 Questions)

Test your mastery of Chapter 15. Write down your answers and justifications before reviewing the detailed correction key below.

Section A: Multiple Choice Questions (Q1 - Q5)

Q1. Pupils at Bridgemary School are grouped in mixed-age classes according to their:

A) Age | B) Ability | C) Behavioral Record | D) Social Status

Q2. Complete the sentence correctly: 'The new system is aimed ____ tackling low performance.'

A) to | B) with | C) at | D) on

Q3. The 'Access Level' at Bridgemary School deals specifically with:

A) Pre-university A-levels | B) High-level science courses | C) Basic literacy and numeracy | D) IT skills

Q4. Which syllable bears the primary accent (stress) in the word 'ability'?

A) First | B) Second | C) Third | D) Fourth

Q5. Complete: 'Struggling students are allocated _____ Access Level.'

A) into | B) for | C) in | D) to

Section B: True or False with Textual Justification (Q6 - Q10)

Q6. Bridgemary School is located in an affluent, rich neighborhood.

Q7. The headmistress was highly praised by Ofsted for her leadership.

Q8. The majority of secondary schools in England employ some form of streaming.

Q9. The chairman of governors is extremely concerned with maintaining comprehensive ideals.

Q10. In the noun 'North' and adjective 'Northern', the 'th' group is pronounced identically.

3.2 Detailed Correction & Pedagogical Analysis

A. Multiple Choice Corrections:

• **Q1: Correct Answer is B (Ability).** The text explicitly states that Bridgemary School will teach all its pupils 'according to their ability rather than their age' in mixed-age classes.

• **Q2: Correct Answer is C (at).** The verb 'aimed' dynamically pairs with 'at' to express intent. Syntactic rule: aim + at + V-ing (e.g., 'aimed at tackling the culture').

• **Q3: Correct Answer is C (Basic literacy and numeracy).** The text specifies: 'Access deals with basic numeracy and literacy, while level three is equivalent to A-levels.'

• **Q4: Correct Answer is B (Second).** Phonetic rule: nouns ending in '-ity' have their stress on the antepenult (third syllable from end), which corresponds to the second syllable in a-**bil**-i-ty (/ə'bilɪti/).

• **Q5: Correct Answer is D (to).** The verb 'allocated' takes the dependent preposition 'to' (e.g., 'allocated to one of five levels').

B. True or False Corrections:

• **Q6: FALSE.** The text states that the school 'is in a deprived urban area' (deprived = poor/disadvantaged).

• **Q7: TRUE.** Mrs. Cheryl Heron was described by schools watchdog Ofsted as an 'excellent leader who was driving the school forward'.

• **Q8: TRUE.** The article estimates that '60 per cent of secondary schools employ some form of streaming'.

• **Q9: FALSE.** The chairman, Dr. Faysal Mikdadi, stated: 'I could not care less about an ideal. I care about whether these children are achieving their potential.'

• **Q10: FALSE.** This is the classic Baccalauréat 'TH' phonetic trap. 'North' contains a voiceless fricative (/θ/ like 'three'), while 'Northern' contains a voiced fricative (/ð/ like 'the').

3.3 Chapter 15 Reference Memos

Table 1.1: Dependent Prepositions & Verbal Structures Cheat-Sheet

Verb / Structure	Preposition	Key Usage Nuance	Tunisian Baccalauréat Example
allocated	to	Assigning resources/people	Students are allocated to entry levels.
aimed	at	Targeting an objective	The reform is aimed at boosting grades.
deals	with	Handling or treating a topic	Access level deals with numeracy.
equivalent	to	Expressing equal status	Level 3 is equivalent to A-levels.
transformed	into	Complete morphological shift	The tutor groups were transformed into sets.
care	about	Feeling concern for a topic	They do not care about old ideals.
suffer	from	Experiencing medical/social distress	Children who suffer from bullying.

Verb / Structure	Preposition	Key Usage Nuance	Tunisian Baccalauréat Example
independent	of	Free from external control	Grades are independent of student age.

Table 1.2: Syllable Stress and Phonetic Shifts

Target Word	Stressed Syllable	Phonetic Transcription (IPA)	Key Stress Rule / Shift Accent
personalised	1st (PER-son-al-ised)	/ˈpɜːsənəlaɪzd/	Maintain stress of root noun 'person'.
ability	2nd (a-BIL-i-ty)	/əˈbɪlɪti/	Suffix '-ity' forces antepenultimate stress.
deprived	2nd (de-PRIVED)	/dɪˈpraɪvd/	Verb prefix 'de-' is unstressed; root is stressed.
numeracy	1st (NU-mer-a-cy)	/ˈnjuːmərəsi/	Noun suffix '-acy' places stress on initial syllable.
achieving	2nd (a-CHIEV-ing)	/əˈtʃiːvɪŋ/	Root verb 'achieve' maintains stress on root.
under-achievement	3rd (achieve root)	/ˌʌndərəˈtʃiːvmənt/	Prefix 'under-' takes secondary stress; root remains primary.